Cognitive Interview Guide

Instructions to read to participants:
We're testing some survey questions with the help of people such as yourself. I'll ask you the questions and want you to answer them just like a regular survey. However, our goal here is to get a better idea of how the questions are working. So, I'd like you to think aloud as you answer the questions—just tell me everything you are thinking about as you go about answering them. At times I'll also stop and ask you more about the questions and what you think a question is asking about. Please keep in mind that I really want to hear all your opinions and reactions. Don't hesitate to speak up whenever something seems unclear, is hard to answer, or doesn't seem to apply to you.

Question	Wording of question	Notes
Q0.	What is the name of the baby you had most recently (irrespective of the outcome of the delivery)?	If the woman had a still birth, or the baby died at some point prior to the date of the interview, take a few minutes, if necessary to accommodate her emotions and ensure she is comfortable enough to proceed with the interview. If she says the baby did not live long enough to be given a name, ask her if you can refer to him/her as "Baby". Remind her that her responses will be kept confidential, and that she can stop you at any time if she no longer wants to participate.
	There will be 4 variants of Question 1: Q101, Q104, Q105 & Q106.	We are testing four different variants of Question 1. What this means for you is that each respondent will be asked only one of the four variants.

		For Question 1, please ask Variant 1/Variant 2/Variant 3/Variant 4. Thereafter, ask all participants Question 2, followed by Question 3. For the questions labeled Q101, Q102, Q104, Q105, Q106, Q201 & Q301, **please ensure you ask the question exactly as it is written.**
	Variant 1	
Q101

	answer? How would you rephrase the question to make it easier to answer? Before I asked you just now, how much thought would you say you have given to this question? ***Sensitivity/bias***: How did you feel about being asked this question? Is this okay to ask about in a survey, or will it make people uncomfortable? Why? ***Reasoning***: Please tell me more about your answer? What were you thinking about when you said <response>? For those who responded to Q102 IF "NO MORE": Can you tell me what you were thinking about that made you say you don't want more children? IF "LATER": Can you tell me what you were thinking about that made you say you wanted more children later? ***Recall***: What time period were you thinking of when answering my question on the timing of [NAME]'s birth? Did you find it difficult or easy to remember your feelings at that time about having a child? How sure are you that you are remembering your feelings at the time about having a child? Do you think your memory of that time is affected by how you feel about [NAME] these days?	It is important to pay close attention to the participant's response and probe accordingly
	Variant 2	
Q104	Now we want to ask you about the time right before you became pregnant with [NAME]. Please think about how you were feeling in those days. Did you want to get pregnant at that time? ☐ **Yes --> Go to Probes** ☐ **No --> Ask Q102**	Please ask Q104 **exactly** as written (DO NOT PARAPHRASE). And read slowly, giving the woman time to think back and recall her feelings.

Q102	Did you want to have a baby later on, or did you not want any (more) children? **<u>Probes</u>:** ***Paraphrase***: Can you repeat the question(s) I just asked, in your own words? **[NOTE TO INTERVIEWER:** If the participant asks you to repeat this question, encourage her to repeat what she heard first before you do so] ***Task difficulty***: Do you find this question easy or hard to answer? IF "EASY": what makes this question easy to answer? IF "HARD": what makes this question difficult to answer? How would you rephrase the question to make it easier to answer? Before I asked you just now, how much thought would you say you have given to this question? ***Sensitivity/bias:*** How did you feel about being asked this question? Is this okay to ask about in a survey, or will it make people uncomfortable? Why? ***Reasoning***: Please tell me more about your answer? What were you thinking about when you said <*response*>? <u>For those who responded to Q102</u> IF "NO MORE": Can you tell me what you were thinking about that made you say you don't want more children? IF "LATER": Can you tell me what you were thinking about that made you say you wanted more children later? ***Recall***: The questions ask you to think back to	Please note that if a woman answers "Yes" to Q104, you will not ask Q102, but rather jump to the probes after Q102. It is imperative that you allow the participant to paraphrase the question in her own words first before you repeat yourself or clarify the question. It is important to pay close attention to the participant's response and probe accordingly It is important to pay close attention to the participant's response and probe accordingly

	the time right before you became pregnant. What can you remember about the time right before you became pregnant with [NAME]? Did you find this difficult or easy to remember? What helped you remember that time? How sure are you that you are remembering your feelings at the time? Do you think your memory of that time is affected by how you feel about [NAME] these days?	
	Variant 3	
Q105 **Q102**	We know that children are a blessing, but sometimes pregnancies occur at a time when a woman would rather not get pregnant. When you got pregnant with [NAME], did you want to get pregnant at that time? ☐ **Yes --> Go to Probes** ☐ **No --> Ask Q402** Did you want to have a baby later on, or did you not want any (more) children? **<u>Probes:</u>** ***Paraphrase:*** Can you repeat the question(s) I just asked, in your own words? What do you think it means for a pregnancy to occur at a time when a woman would rather not get pregnant? **[NOTE TO INTERVIEWER:** If the participant asks you to repeat this question, encourage her to repeat what she heard first before you do so] ***Task difficulty:*** Do you find this question easy or hard to answer? IF "EASY": what makes this question easy to answer? IF "HARD": what makes this question difficult to answer? How would you rephrase the question to make it easier to answer? Before I asked you just now, how much thought	Please ask Q105 **exactly** as written (DO NOT PARAPHRASE) Please note that if a woman answers "Yes" to Q105, you will not ask Q102, but rather jump to the probes after Q102. It is imperative that you allow the participant to paraphrase the question in her own words first before you repeat yourself or clarify the question. It is important to pay close attention to the participant's response and probe accordingly

	would you say you have given to this question? ***Sensitivity/bias:*** How did you feel about being asked this question? Is this okay to ask about in a survey, or will it make people uncomfortable? Why? ***Reasoning:*** Please tell me more about your answer? What were you thinking about when you said <response>? For those who responded to Q102 IF "NO MORE": Can you tell me what you were thinking about that made you say you don't want more children? IF "LATER": Can you tell me what you were thinking about that made you say you wanted more children later? ***Recall:*** What time period where you thinking of when answering my question on the timing of [NAME]'s birth? Did you find this difficult or easy to remember? Would you say the time period when you became pregnant was a good time for the pregnancy to occur? What helped you remember that time? How sure are you that you are remembering your feelings at the time? Do you think your memory of that time is affected by how you feel about [NAME] these days?	It is important to pay close attention to the participant's response and probe accordingly
	Variant 4	
Q106	We know that children are a blessing, but sometimes pregnancies occur at a time when a woman would rather not get pregnant. Now we want to ask you about the time right before you became pregnant with [NAME]. Please think about how you were feeling in those days. Did you want to get pregnant at that time? ☐**Yes --> Go to Probes**	Please ask Q106 **exactly** as written (DO NOT PARAPHRASE). And read slowly, giving the woman time to think back and recall her feelings.

	☐ **No --> Ask Q102**	
Q102	Did you want to have a baby later on, or did you not want any (more) children? **<u>Probes</u>:** ***Paraphrase***: Can you repeat the question(s) I just asked, in your own words? What do you think it means for a pregnancy to occur at a time when a woman would rather not get pregnant? **[NOTE TO INTERVIEWER:** If the participant asks you to repeat this question, encourage her to repeat what she heard first before you do so] ***Task difficulty***: Do you find this question easy or hard to answer? IF "EASY": what makes this question easy to answer? IF "HARD": what makes this question difficult to answer? How would you rephrase the question to make it easier to answer? Before I asked you just now, how much thought would you say you have given to this question? ***Sensitivity/bias:*** How did you feel about being asked this question? Is this okay to ask about in a survey, or will it make people uncomfortable? Why? ***Reasoning***: Please tell me more about your answer? What were you thinking about when you said <*response*>? <u>For those who responded to Q102</u> IF "NO MORE": Can you tell me what you were thinking about that made you say you don't want more children?	Please note that if a woman answers "Yes" to Q106, you will not ask Q102, but rather jump to the probes after Q102. It is imperative that you allow the participant to paraphrase the question in her own words first before you repeat yourself or clarify the question. It is important to pay close attention to the participant's response and probe accordingly It is important to pay close attention to the participant's

	IF "LATER": Can you tell me what you were thinking about that made you say you wanted more children later? ***Recall***: The question ask you to think back to the time right before you became pregnant. What can you remember about the time right before you became pregnant with [NAME]? Did you find this difficult or easy to remember? What helped you remember that time? Would you say that time period was a good time for the pregnancy to occur? How sure are you that you are remembering your feelings at the time? Do you think your memory of that time is affected by how you feel about [NAME] these days?	response and probe accordingly
	QUESTION 2	
Q201	Now I have a question about the future. Would you like to have another child, or would you prefer not to have any more children? **<u>Probes:</u>** ***Paraphrase***: Can you repeat the question I just asked, in your own words? **[NOTE TO INTERVIEWER:** If the participant asks you to repeat this question, encourage her to repeat what she heard first before you do so] ***Task difficulty***: Do you find this question easy or hard to answer? IF "EASY": what makes this question easy to answer? IF "HARD": What makes it hard to answer? How would you rephrase the question to make it easier to answer?	Please ask Q201 **exactly** as written (DO NOT PARAPHRASE) It is imperative that you allow the participant to paraphrase the question in her own words first before you repeat yourself or clarify the question. It is important to pay close attention to the participant's response and probe accordingly

	Before I asked you just now, how much thought would you say you have given to this question? ***Confidence***: Do you think your answer would be the same if I talked to you in a year or so? Or how about if I had asked you this question a year or so ago – do you think your answer would have been the same? ***Reasoning***: How did you arrive at your answer? What were you thinking about when you said <*response*>? Can you tell me the reasons why you said <*response*>. When you said <*response*>, were you imagining that your situation would remain as it is these days, get better, or get worse? What aspects of your situation were you thinking about when you said <remain the same/get better/get worse>? Which aspects of your situation do you think might <*get better*> <*get worse*> ? In answering the question, were you thinking at all about whether or not you could get pregnant quickly/easily? In answering the question, were you thinking mainly about your own wishes, or were you also thinking about what other persons would want? This could be your husband, or other persons in your family or community. In answering the question, were you thinking about whether it's a good idea to have another child with your current partner?	
	QUESTION 3	
Q301	If you could go back to the time you did not have any children and could choose exactly the number of children to have in your whole life, how many would that be?	Please ask Q301 **exactly** as written (DO NOT PARAPHRASE)

	<u>Probes:</u> ***Paraphrase***: Can you repeat the question I just asked, in your own words? In your own words, what do you think this question is asking you about? **[NOTE TO INTERVIEWER:** If the participant asks you to repeat this question, encourage her to repeat what she heard first before you do so] **[*IF RESPONDENT GIVES A RANGE*]** I am interested in why you answered with a range – you said [***repeat the response***] **–** rather than one number. Can you please explain why this range is the best answer for you? ***Task difficulty***: Did you find it easy or difficult to decide what answer to give? IF "EASY": what makes this question easy to answer? IF "HARD": what makes this question difficult to answer? How would you rephrase the question to make it easier to answer? Before I asked you just now, how much thought would you say you have given to this question? Is this a question you've thought about previously? ***Confidence*:** Do you think your answer would be the same if I talked to you in a year or so? Or how about if I had asked you this question a year or so ago – do you think your answer would have been the same? ***Reasoning***: How did you arrive at your answer? What were you thinking about when you said <*response*>? Can you tell me the reasons you say <*response*>? Please explain to me all the reasons you say <*response*>. In answering this question, were you thinking about how many boys and how many girls	It is imperative that you allow the participant to paraphrase the question in her own words first before you repeat yourself or clarify the question. This question must be asked if the participant gives a range or more than one response (e.g., 3-4; 3 maybe 4) It is important to pay close attention to the participant's response and probe accordingly

	you'd like to have? In answering this question, were you imagining that your financial situation would be the same as it is now, or were you imagining that it would be better, or get worse? You say <*response*>, but suppose you end up with <*one less than response*> -- how much would this upset you? <*same for two less*> <*same for one more and two more*> What is the ideal number of children you would like to have? What if, in addition to asking you for the number of children you would like to have in your whole life, I had added that you could indicate that you would like as many children as you are able to have. Would you have chosen this option? How many children would be too few for you? And how many children would be too many for you?	For this probe you will ask the participant four questions: -one less than their response -two less than their response -one more than their response -two more than their response
	Thank you very much for your time, and for sharing your experiences with me.	Always remember to thank the participant for their time.